

STATE OF NEW YORK

3929--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

January 30, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. DINOWITZ, KAY, LEVENBERG, ALVAREZ, TAPIA, SHIMSKY, CUNNINGHAM, GLICK, O'PHARROW, LUNSFORD, KASSAY -- read once and referred to the Committee on Election Law -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the election law, in relation to requiring social media influencers to disclose when they share on social media that they are being paid by a campaign; and authorizes the state board of elections to promulgate certain regulations

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Section 14-106 of the election law, as amended by chapter
2 454 of the laws of 2019, subdivisions 5 and 6 as added by section 1 of
3 subpart B of part MM of chapter 58 of the laws of 2024, paragraph (b) of
4 subdivision 5 as amended and subdivision 7 as added by chapter 169 of
5 the laws of 2024, is amended to read as follows:
6 § 14-106. Political communication. 1. The statements required to be
7 filed under the provisions of this article next succeeding a primary,
8 general or special election shall be accompanied by a copy of all broad-
9 cast, cable or satellite schedules and scripts, paid internet or
10 digital, including social media posts made by individuals being paid by
11 the campaign to make such social media posts on behalf of a particular
12 candidate, election, ballot measure or other political issue, print and
13 other types of advertisements, pamphlets, circulars, flyers, brochures,
14 letterheads and other printed matter purchased or produced, and repro-
15 ductions of statements or information published to five hundred or more
16 members of a general public audience by computer or other electronic
17 device including but not limited to electronic mail or text message,
18 purchased in connection with such election by or under the authority of
19 the person filing the statement or the committee or the person on whose
20 behalf it is filed, as the case may be. Such copies, schedules and

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 scripts shall be preserved by the officer with whom or the board with
2 which it is required to be filed for a period of one year from the date
3 of filing thereof.

4 2. All political committees that make an expenditure for a political
5 communication shall be required to disclose the identity of the political
6 committee which made the expenditure for such political communication.
7 The disclosure on printed or digital political communications,
8 including but not limited to brochures, flyers, posters, mailings, or
9 internet advertising, including social media posts made by individuals
10 being paid by the campaign, shall be printed or typed in an appropriate
11 legible form to read as follows: "Paid for by:" followed by the name of
12 the political committee making the expenditure. The disclosure on non-
13 printed or digital political communications shall clearly and prominently
14 display and/or speak the following statement: "Paid for by:"
15 followed by the name of the political committee making the expenditure.
16 In the case of a political communication that is not visual, such as
17 radio or automated telephone calls, clearly speaking the statement will
18 satisfy the requirements of this section.

19 3. Political communications that are considered promotional items
20 which support a particular candidate, election, ballot measure or issue
21 and limit the content of communication to the name, office and brief
22 message of support, shall be exempt from the provisions of subdivision
23 two of this section. Promotional items shall be items that are of nominal
24 value and are distributed to the general public in an effort to
25 promote a particular candidate, election, ballot measure or issue
26 including but not limited to pens, bumper stickers, yard signs, buttons,
27 shirts, bags or balloons.

28 4. Political communication that is considered digital media which
29 advertises for a particular candidate, election, ballot measure or issue
30 which limits the content of communication to the name, office and brief
31 message shall not be subject to the provisions of subdivision two of
32 this section if such digital media is unable to contain the "paid for
33 by" statement due to its small size and contains a link to another
34 webpage where the "paid for by" statement is prominently displayed.
35 Social media posts made on behalf of a particular candidate, election,
36 ballot measure or other issue shall not be exempted from the provisions
37 of this section.

38 5. (a) For purposes of this subdivision:

39 (i) "Materially deceptive media" means any image, video, audio, text,
40 or any technological representation of speech or conduct fully or
41 partially created or modified that:

42 (1) exhibits a high level of authenticity or convincing appearance
43 that is visually or audibly indistinguishable from reality to a reasonable
44 person;

45 (2) depicts a scenario that did not actually occur or that has been
46 altered in a significant way from how they actually occurred; and

47 (3) is created by or with software, machine learning, artificial
48 intelligence, or any other computer-generated or technological means,
49 including adapting, modifying, manipulating, or altering a realistic
50 depiction.

51 (ii) "Information content provider" means any person or entity that is
52 responsible, in whole or in part, for the creation or development of
53 information provided through the Internet or any other interactive
54 computer service.

55 (b) (i) A person, firm, association, corporation, campaign, committee,
56 or organization that distributes or publishes any political communi-

1 cation that was produced by or includes materially deceptive media and
2 has actual knowledge that it is materially deceptive shall be required
3 to disclose this use.

4 (ii) (1) For visual media the disclosure shall be printed or typed in
5 a legible font size easily readable by the average viewer that is no
6 smaller than other text appearing in the visual media and in the same
7 language used on the communication to read as follows: "This (image,
8 video, or audio) has been manipulated".

9 (2) For communication that is auditory, such as radio or automated
10 telephone calls, clearly speaking the statement at the beginning of the
11 audio, at the end of the audio, and, if the audio is greater than two
12 minutes in length, interspersed within the audio at intervals of not
13 greater than two minutes each and in the same language as the rest of
14 the audio used in the communication, and in a pitch that can be easily
15 heard by the average listener satisfies the requirements of clause one
16 of this subparagraph.

17 (iii) This paragraph shall not apply to the following:

18 (1) materially deceptive media that constitutes satire or parody;

19 (2) materially deceptive media distributed by a bona fide news report-
20 ing entity for the purpose of news reporting or coverage, if the report-
21 ing clearly acknowledges through content or a disclosure, in a manner
22 that can be easily read or heard by the average listener or viewer, that
23 there are questions about the authenticity of the materially deceptive
24 media;

25 (3) a radio or television broadcasting station, including a cable
26 television, satellite television or streaming service operator, program-
27 mer, producer or other similar entity, that broadcasts a political
28 communication when the station or streaming service is paid to broadcast
29 the political communication if the station or streaming service can show
30 that it has disclaimer requirements that are consistent with the
31 requirements provided in this paragraph and that it provided those
32 disclaimer requirements to each person or entity that purchased the
33 broadcast or streaming of the advertisement; or

34 (4) initial dissemination by a platform or service including, but not
35 limited to, a website, regularly published newspaper, or magazine, where
36 the content disseminated is materially deceptive media provided by
37 another information content provider.

38 (iv) A candidate whose voice or likeness appears in materially decep-
39 tive media in violation of this subdivision may seek reasonable court
40 costs and attorneys' fees and injunctive relief prohibiting the distrib-
41 ution, publication or broadcasting of any materially deceptive media in
42 violation of this subdivision against such individual or entity who
43 disseminated or published such media without the consent of the person
44 depicted and who knew or should have known that it was materially decep-
45 tive. An action under this paragraph shall be initiated by filing an
46 application for an order to show cause in the supreme court where the
47 materially deceptive media at issue could deceive and influence electors
48 in an upcoming election. Such action shall be entitled to an automatic
49 calendar preference and be subject to expedited pretrial and trial
50 proceedings.

51 (v) In any action alleging a violation of this subdivision in which a
52 plaintiff seeks preliminary relief with respect to an upcoming election,
53 the court shall grant relief if it determines that:

54 (A) plaintiffs are more likely than not to succeed on the merits; and

55 (B) it is possible to implement an appropriate remedy that would
56 resolve the alleged violation in the upcoming election.

1 (vi) In any action commenced under this subdivision, the plaintiff
2 bears the burden of establishing the use of materially deceptive media
3 by clear and convincing evidence.

4 6. Nothing in this section shall be construed to limit, or to enlarge,
5 the protections that 47 U.S.C. § 230 confers on an interactive computer
6 service for content provided by another information content provider, as
7 such terms are defined in 47 U.S.C. § 230.

8 7. Nothing in this section shall be construed to require entities to
9 cancel, edit, or insert video or audio labels into political communi-
10 cations where such action is inconsistent with federal law.

11 8. The state board of elections is authorized to promulgate additional
12 regulations pertaining to the method of filing statements required to be
13 provided pursuant to this section. Such regulations shall be promulgated
14 within ninety days of the effective date of this subdivision.

15 § 2. This act shall take effect on the ninetieth day after it shall
16 have become a law.